the outcomes was a Joint Strategic Vision for the Asia-Pacific and Indian Ocean Region, which presaged future cooperation between India and the United States in the Indo–Pacific. [27] Another significant development involved India becoming a Major Defense Partner of the United States, a status that granted it many of the benefits of US treaty allies, such as access to advanced defence technologies, but without any obligations such as a mutual defence treaty, combined commands, or basing arrangements.

The notion of the Indo–Pacific had been in circulation for some time in academic circles. But it took off with its adoption by the Japanese, Australian, Indian, and—eventually—US governments. [28] Modi's first visit to the United States after Donald Trump's election as US president made some progress in bilateral cooperation in 2017. This contrasted with other world leaders' challenging meetings with Trump, who had campaigned on an anti-establishment platform. Nevertheless, under Trump, the United States began to officially articulate its Indo–Pacific strategy following Secretary of State Rex Tillerson's visit to India in September 2017 and the release of a National Security Strategy in December of that year. [29] Notionally, the Indo–Pacific recognized the Pacific and Indian Oceans as a strategic continuum, the importance of the maritime domain for security and commerce, and the role of India in the regional balance of power. It contrasted with the narrower vision for the Asia–Pacific that had been in vogue in the early 1990s, and which led to the exclusion of India and the Indian Ocean in forums such as the Asia Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) summit. India did not issue an official and public Indo–Pacific strategy, but Modi articulated India's approach to the region in a speech at the Shangri-la Dialogue in Singapore in 2018. [30]

Relations with the United States, Japan, and Australia all began to take off in this period. Bilateral and trilateral military exercises involving all three military services proliferated. India concluded a series of foundational agreements with the United States that enabled mutual logistics support, secure communications, and geospatial data sharing—agreements that the United States had long insisted were necessary for strong functional military-to-military interoperability. Political consultations also increased in